Minor Innovative enterpreneurship Customer Development

Gino Thuij – 17 February 2025

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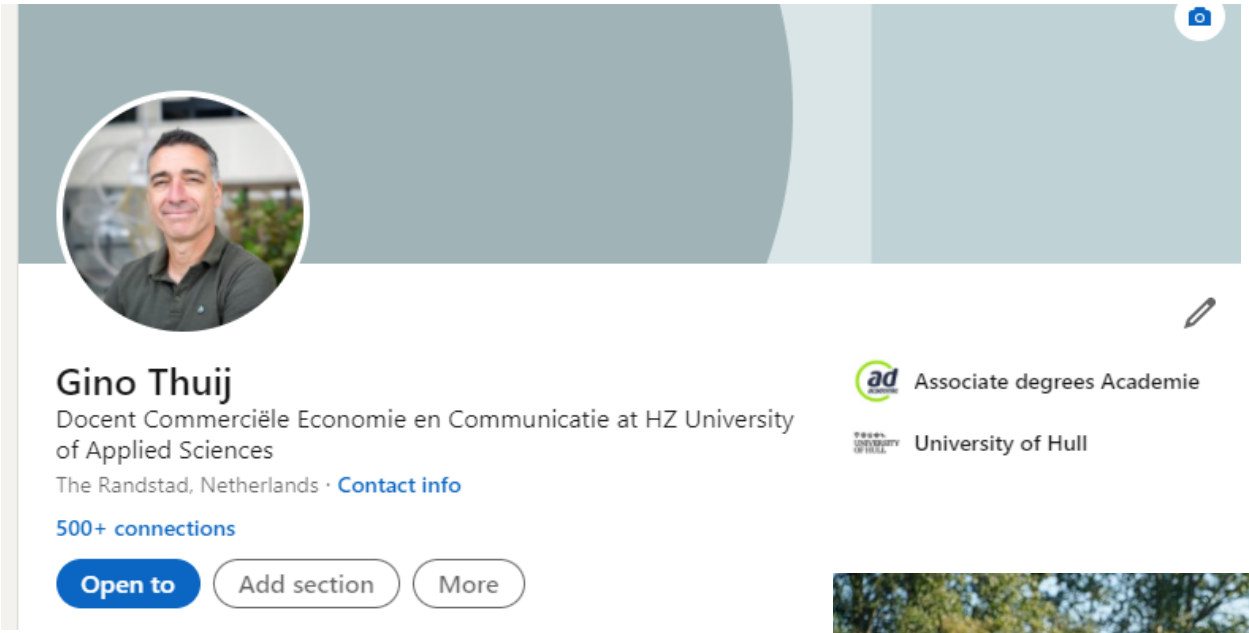
De persoonlijke hogeschool

Who am I?



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GfK

VEST ROCK

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Todays agenda

- Short introduction
- Get to know your target group
- Deliverable 1: Make a **persona** of your target group
- The (ideal) customer journey
- Deliverable 2: Make a conceptual **customer journey** for that customer

Short introduction of you and your business

- Name, which problem do you solve, who is the target group?

Target group

Factors that might influence your choice on which group to target:

- **Mission** of your business
- What is it that you want **to achieve**?
- Which roles can you define relevant to your product/service? (B2B (DMU), B2C)
- Which **problem** is it, that you solve?

"A defined group of people/institutions that a product/service/campaign/organization focuses on"

Why is knowledge of your target group important?

Knowledge of your potential customers…

- Gives you **better insights** on the behavior and needs
- Makes the product **better fit** with the needs
- Will create **more empathy** for your target group
- Gives you **effectiveness** and **focus**
- Will result in more clear and **better decionmaking**
- Will improve the **customer experience**

What is customer experience?

- “What people really desire are not products but satisfying experiences”
- “Customer experience is a multidimensional construct focusing on a customer’s **cognitive, emotional, behavioral**, **sensorial** and **social** responses to a firm’s offerings during the customer’s entire purchase journey”
- Is the result of every interaction a customer has with your business

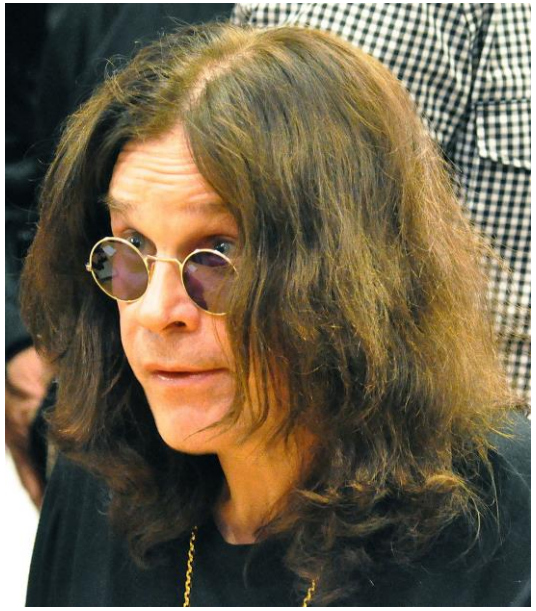
Defining your customer

Your target group

- Is the selective group of people (or businesses) that have the same challenges, problems, that you want to focus on with your business (solution).
- Do share relevant **criteria** that fit your target group
- Those criteria are not the same for everybody or every business
- Try to focus on **validating** their problem
- Also, how can you use this information later in the process in terms of **customer knowledge**?

Demographics are quite the same

Age, country of residence, both married, both rich..



But what defines the difference between these guys?

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Do these men fit in the same target group?

That depends…

Let’s test

How to define the target group of these magazines?

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What do you already know based on the interviews?

Write down everything you already know and categorize it

- Demographic (who)
- Geographical criteria (where)
- Psychographic (why)
- Behavioral (how)

Categorization

4 TYPES OF MARKET SEGMENTATION

Socio-demographic

- Age
- Gender
- Income
- Education
- Occupation
- Family size
- Marital status

Geographic

- The city
- The country
- Climate
- The region
- Neighbourhood
- Size of the city

Psychographic

- Values
- Interests
- Opinions
- Attitudes
- Beliefs
- Lifestyles
- Purchasing behaviour

Behavioural

- The period of purchase
- Frequency of purchase
- Price sensitivity
- Brand loyalty
- Product use
- Reaction to advertising

Deliverable 1: Create your persona's

Focus on their behavior and what they do

"Personas are fictional characters, which you create based upon your research in order to represent the different user types that might use your service, product, site, or brand in a similar way"

Persona

- A hypothetical type of a real user (Ferreira et al. , 2015)
- Instead of ‘static’knowledge, you bring the knowlege ‘to life’.
- You give your target group a face, a name and a full relevant discription
- You try to get to know this persona
- You visualise a persona as one person, but in fact it’s a representation of multiple persons in a target group
- Based on facts → research!!
- Dynamic → keep improving

Persona

- Widespread adoption and understanding (Pruitt&Grudin, 2003)
- You can use the persona for future products
- A tool for decision making criteria
- Communication policy (new finding can instantly be communicated)
- User focus and awareness
- Make assumptions more explicit by creating a persona

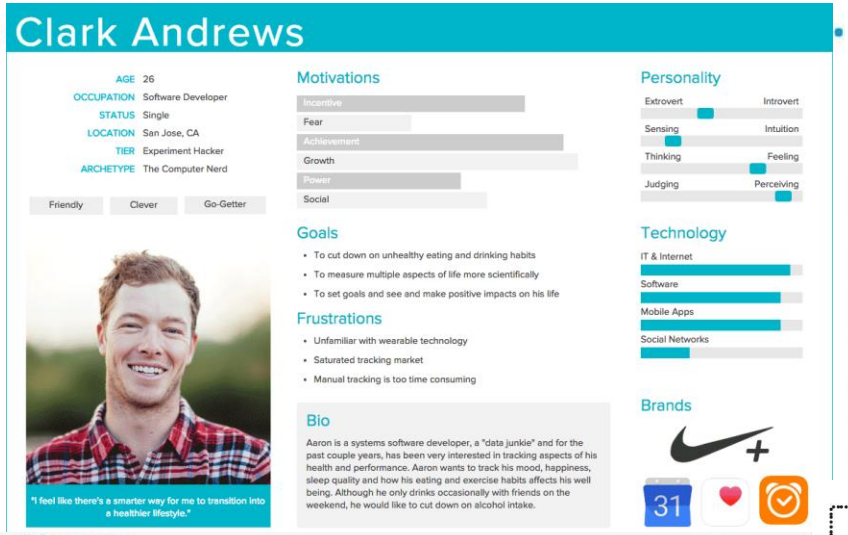
Which characteristics are important for you?

- Get to know the person (demographics, family, profession etc.)
- A day in the life
- Psychological characteristics
- Needs
- Leisure
- Consumer behavior (buying, search, content approach)
- Technology
- Brands etc.
- Inspiration
- Quotes
- What is important for **you** to know?

B2C and B2B

Bases	Needs, wants benefits, solutions to problems, usage situation, usage rate.	Needs, wants benefits, solutions to problems, usage situation, usage rate, size*, industrial*.
Demographics	Age, income, marital status, family type & size, gender, social class, etc.	Industry, size, location, current supplier(s), technology utilization, etc.
Psychographics	Lifestyle, values, & personality characteristics.	Personality characteristics of decision makers.
Behavior	Use occasions, usage level, complementary & substitute products used, brand loyalty, etc.	Use occasions, usage level, complementary & substitute products used, brand loyalty, order size, applications, etc.
Decision Making	Individual or group (family) choice, low or high involvement purchase, attitudes and knowledge about product class, price sensitivity, etc.price sensitivity	Formalization of purchasing procedures, size & characteristics of decision making group, use of outside consultants, purchasing criteria, (de) centralizing buying,
Media Patterns	Level of use, types of media used, times of use, etc.	Level of use, types of media used, time of use, patronage at trade shows, receptivity of sales people, etc.

DIFFERENT FORMS OF PERSONA'S



An empathy map can help you to describe your persona

Field	Guiding Questions
Do	What is common for him / her to say?
	How does s/he normally act?
	What are his / her hobbies?
	What does he like to say?
	How is the world in which s/he lives?
	What do people around him / her do?
	Who are his / her friends?
	What is popular in his daily life?
	What people and ideas influence him / her?
	What do the important people in his / her life say? What are his / her favorite brands?
	Who are his / her idols?
Think	What are some important ideas that s/he thinks and does not say?
Feel	How does s/he feel about life?
	What bothers him / her lately? Why?
Pains (Difficulties / Frustrations)	What is s/he afraid of?
	What are his / her frustrations? What has disturbed him? What would s/he like to change in his / her life?
Needs	What does s/he need to feel better?
	What is success? What does s/he want to achieve? What has s/he done to be happy?
	What would end his / her pain? What are some of his / her dreams?

- Increasing **the user experience** by understanding **the needs and emotions** while interacting with the product/service
- It goes **beyond demographic characteristics** and develops a better understandig of the customer's environment, behavior, aspirations and concerns from their perspective (Osterwalder, 2013).
- Create empathy for the specific persona
- See the world through the eyes of the persona

Deliverable 1

Next 30 minutes

- Formulate the characteristics you want to know about your target group
- With visuals and words to describe your main target group(s)
- Its not about structure and being organized, but it is about creativity and visualize the target group
- An outsider should understand the story behind the moodboard without telling it
- Finetune later this week!

You can use this template

But add/remove (ir)relevant categories

- Template @ Learn

- Or go to website xtensio.com
- Make an account
- Choose the category Marketing
- Make a user/buyer persona template

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Customer journey mapping

Customer journey mapping

What is a customer journey?

- “Visualization of the entire experience and outline everything a user does, encounters, thinks and feels with a brand across touchpoints”
- “Documents that visually illustrate customers’ processess, needs, and perceptions throughout their relationship with a company”.

Touch points

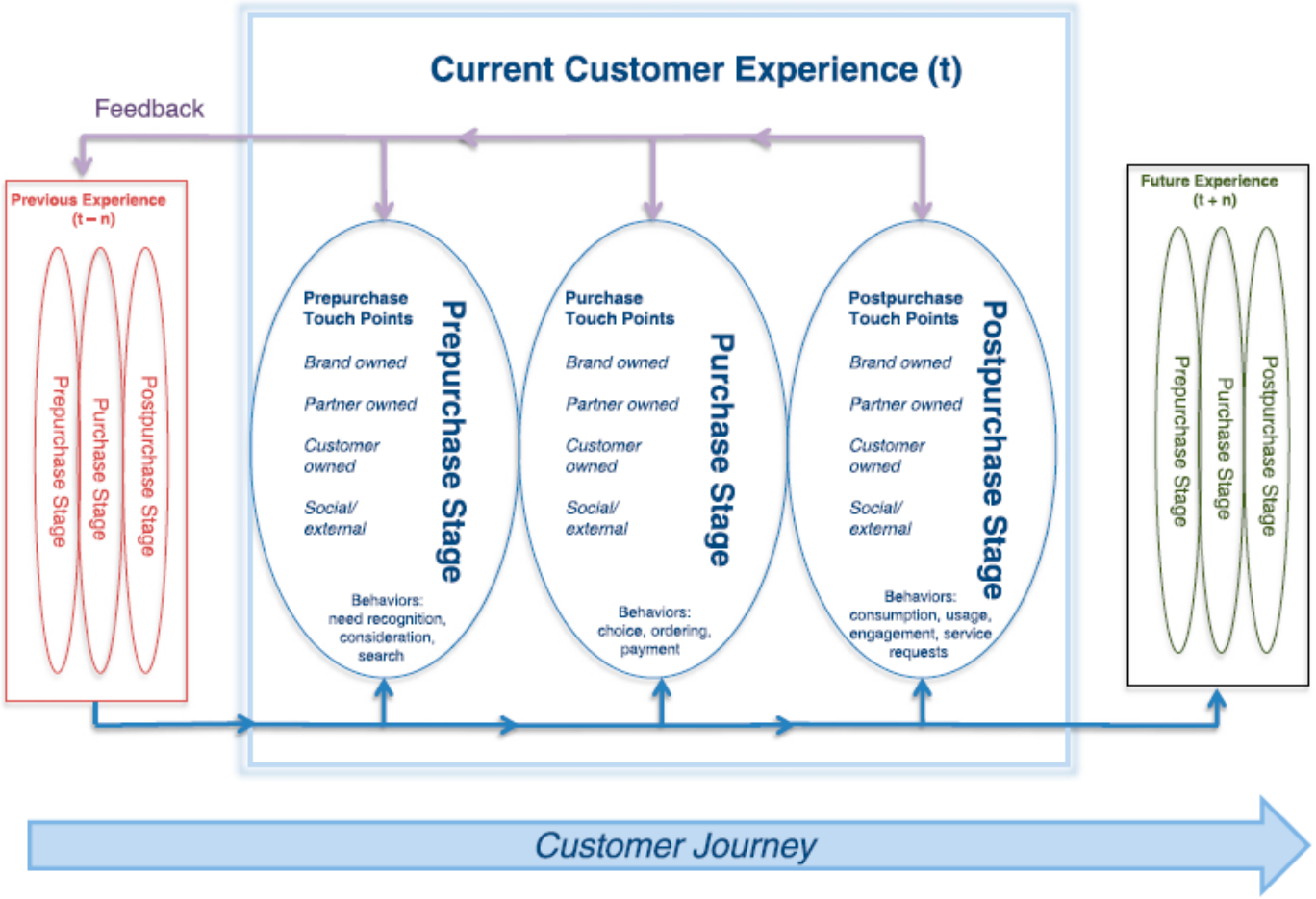
- *"A touchpoint is any interaction (including encounters where there is no physical interaction) that might change the way that your customer feels about your product, brand, business or service."*
- "Contacts between the firm and the customer at distinct points in the experience".
- We are interested in those interactions!

➔ Improvement of the **customer experience**

➔ Related to your targetgroup

Phases in the journey

Phases in the journey



Phases in the journey

BUYER JOURNEY MAP

	1 TRIGGER	2 REVIEW	3 PURCHASE DECISION	4 ENGAGEMENT	5 RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT	6 RENEWAL
	What triggers awareness of the supplier/product?	What is used to explore potential suppliers and to assess their offerings?	What criteria are evaluated to select the chosen supplier?	How does the onboarding process unfold?	What shapes the customer experience?	What prompts contract renewal?
GOAL	Enter the prospect's mindset and drive a call to action.	Meet the prospect's need for information better than that of competitors.	Provide evidence on being the best fit (including a deep understanding of the prospect's needs).	Enable a seamless onboarding process.	Ensure the customer has the best experience possible.	Stay engaged with customers and drive renewal.
TOUCHPOINTS	Direct mail Email advertising Word of mouth / Customer referrals Distributor/dealer reps Distributor/dealer websites Distributor/dealer advertising Retailer reps Retailer websites Retailer advertising Organic search results Social media Online advertising (e.g. paid search, banner ads) Industry trade shows Vendor-specific conferences Print advertising TV advertising Radio advertising Outdoor advertising / billboards Sponsorship (sports, events, charity, etc.) PR Directories	Brochures / catalogues / spec sheets Customer reviews / testimonials Peer referrals Third party / expert reviews Direct sales reps Website White papers Webinars Video Podcasts Infographics Distributor/dealer reps Distributor/dealer websites Retailer reps Retailer websites PR Professional associations / communities	Case studies Pitch / presentation Deliverables Best practices / accreditations ROI data / tools Awards Testimonials	Contract negotiation (pricing, terms, conditions, etc.) Invoicing Stakeholder buy-in Account management / communications / support Training	Customer service / account management Technical support Ordering Shipping / receiving Voice of the customer (performance monitoring) Market research Dashboard / portal Mobile apps Customer events User groups / communities Hospitality / entertainment Email communications Direct mail Webinars Social media	Account management / relations Loyalty programs Referral programs Performance reviews Contract negotiation (discounts, terms etc.) Hospitality / entertainment Vendor-specific conferences Newsletters Infographics Brochures / catalogues White papers Webinars Podcasts Social media

B2B International

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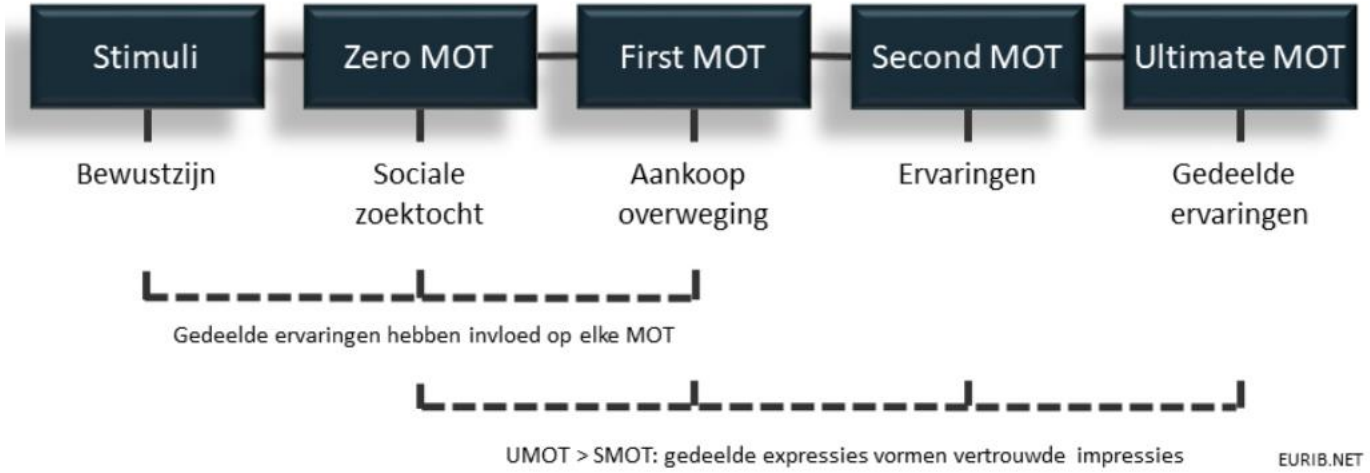
Moment of truth

- **Moment of truth** (MOT) in marketing, is the moment when a customer/user interacts with a brand, product or service to form or change an impression about that particular brand, product or service.

- Zero moment of truth (ZMOT)
- First moment of truth (FMOT)
- Second moment of truth (SMOT)



Customer journey 1,2 and 3

- Customer journey 1.0

The customer journey based on your current (desk) research and assumptions

- Customer journey 2.0
- The customer journey based on customer insights
- Customer journey 3.0
- The ideal customer journey based on recommendations and improvements

Customer Journey voorbeeld: sportschool

motivaction
research and strategy

Klantprofiel

Michiel
28 jaar
Amersfoort
zzp´er
bouwsector

Customer jobs

- ✓ Zich zeker voelen over zijn uiterlijk en lichaam
- ✓ Indruk maken op vrienden/familie
- ✓ Een fysieke uitdaging opzoeken
- ✓ Nieuwe mensen ontmoeten

Touchpoints

- Touchpoint
- Belangrijk touchpoint
- Zeer belangrijk touchpoint

Aanleiding

Michiel krijgt een buikje en dat stoort hem. Zijn vrienden sporten allemaal en hij ziet continu strakke lichamen voorbij komen. Het wordt tijd dat hij zich ook eens gaat inschrijven bij een sportschool!

Oriëntatie

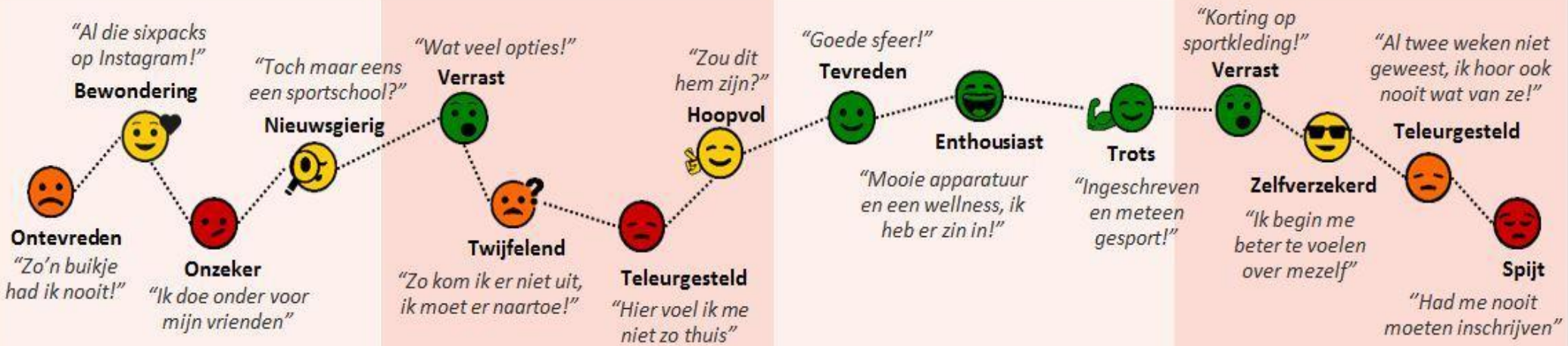
De zoektocht begint online en de favorieten bezoekt Michiel fysiek. Hij overweegt de afstand vanaf zijn huis, of hij met de auto kan, het lesrooster en de tijden, de prijs en ervaringen van vrienden en bekenden.

Lid worden

Een prettig persoonlijk contact bij binnenkomst en de sfeer bepalen de eerste indruk. Een gezellige bar, moderne apparatuur en de aanwezigheid van een sauna en massage geven de doorslag.

Stick-to-it

Michiel heeft het nodig om blijvend gemotiveerd te worden door zijn sportschool, het liefst op een persoonlijke manier. Als dit niet gebeurt, verliest hij snel zijn motivatie en komt hij uiteindelijk helemaal niet meer.



Touchpoints Aanleiding

- Instagram
- Vrienden/peers
- YouTube
- Sportmagazines
- TV-campagne fitnessketens

Touchpoints Oriëntatie

- Google
- Websites van sportscholen
- Bezoek fysieke vestiging
- Medewerkers sportschool
- Folder van sportschool

Touchpoints Lid worden

- Contact met medewerkers
- Contact met medesporters
- Aandacht van personal trainer
- Welkomstcadeau
- Kortingsbon voor sportwinkel

Touchpoints Stick-to-it

- Contact met medewerkers
- Gerichte communicatie
- Persoonlijk advies
- Ledenvoordeel

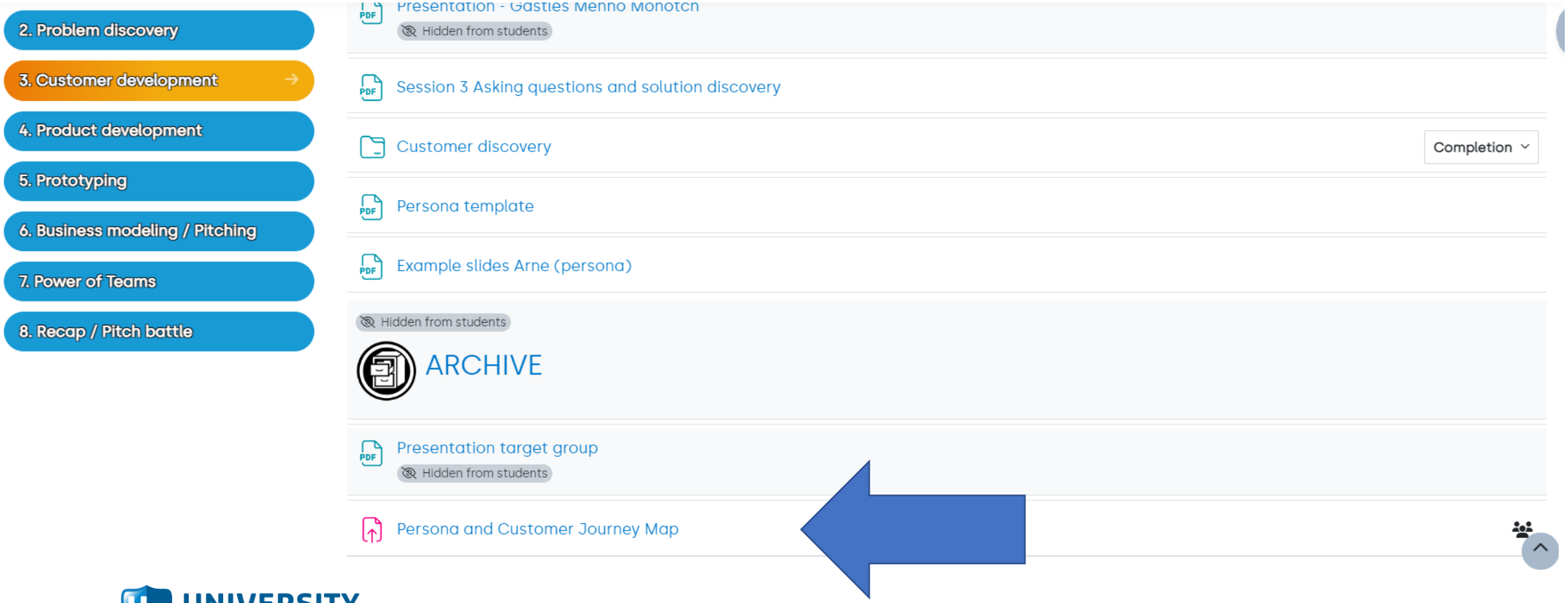
Customer journey (deliverable 2)

- For the time left:
- Answer the questions in the ‘customer journey map’ assignment which are:
    - What stages are defined in your customer journey map?
    - What actions does your persona undertake in the stages?
    - Are they positive or negative experiences?
    - What are your observations?
    - Try to focus on the first stages (including the awareness and consideration phase)

- Again; finetune later this week : make it visual!

- Dont be shy to be creative! But again: keep the customer in mind

Inleveren op Learn uiterlijk zondag



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What's left?

- Keep improving the deliverables by doing research (qualitative and quantitative, and desk research)
- Not only this week, but also in the (nearby) future.
- These products are never finished

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